

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1004

By Keisling

A RESOLUTION to honor and congratulate Faye Strong Watson upon her induction into the Clay County Sports Hall of Fame.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that this General Assembly pay tribute to those gifted athletes, coaches, and administrators who have attained the very pinnacle of sporting achievement; and

WHEREAS, Faye Strong Watson is one such legendary three-sport athlete, who was recently inducted into the Clay County Sports Hall of Fame; and

WHEREAS, an iconic figure within the community, Ms. Watson enjoyed one of the longest careers in local sports history, either playing or coaching for nearly six decades from 1960 to 2018; and

WHEREAS, Faye Strong Watson's historic athletic career began on a dirt basketball court at Moss Elementary School, continued at Celina High School on the hardwood, kept rolling on the softball diamond, and culminated with an impressive tennis career; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Watson was the leading scorer on a Moss basketball team that defeated Celina in elementary school, before the two teams came together at Celina High School to form one of the best squads the legendary John Teeples ever coached; and

WHEREAS, before graduating in 1965, Faye Strong Watson was a three-year letterman in basketball and a part-time starter during her senior year, playing with four future Clay County Hall of Fame members; and

WHEREAS, after playing slow-pitch softball for many years, Ms. Watson became the first-ever Celina High School fast-pitch softball coach; starting the program in 1986, she expertly coached and mentored her players, and they soon bonded together to become the best team in the area; and

WHEREAS, her Lady Dawgs finished as district runners-up in 1987, won the district championship in 1988, and claimed both the district championship and the region championship in 1989 to advance to the sub-state round, an accomplishment that still stands unequalled in Celina softball history; and

WHEREAS, Faye Strong Watson was also a dominant tennis player who won over 300 matches over the course of four decades (1978-2018), playing in leagues and tournaments all across Tennessee and Kentucky; and

WHEREAS, Ms. Watson excelled as a singles player, but she also played doubles and mixed doubles; among her many titles, she won the UTSA-sanctioned forties-age-class tournament and the UTSA regional doubles state championship and played in the national region championship; and

WHEREAS, Faye Strong Watson demonstrated leadership, skill, and versatility throughout her long and prolific athletic career, and it is fitting that we should honor her on this special occasion; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Faye Strong Watson upon her induction into the Clay County Sports Hall of Fame and extend to her our best wishes for much continued success and happiness.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.